

The Case of the EQ Peg Hoax 25 Years Ago: Would a Replay in Today's Media Be the Same?

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Abstract

Potential media reactions to a SETI detection event remain the subject of debate. The EQ Peg event of 1998, which mimicked media reaction to a potential detection a quarter of a century ago, presents an interesting case when viewed in the light of media reactions today. While the claimed detection proved to be a hoax, the story reverberated around the world for five days - a much shorter time than it would take for a potential detection to be confirmed. The event led to two consecutive articles by the authors of this paper. One study examined the response of the media and SETI scientists to the claim, and the other proposed an Immediate Reaction Plan, emphasising the need for such a plan in the face of potential future events. What have we learned from this event in the past 25 years? Today, fake news, polarisation, and alternative realities spread rapidly across social media. Societal divisions have deepened, and conspiracy theories abound. More recently, generative artificial intelligence news chatbots have presented novel challenges in communicating the SETI enterprise to public audiences, while also creating new opportunities to help direct conversations. Understanding and utilising these media changes is not just a matter of interest, but a fundamental need for SETI in connecting with the public, should it discover the answer to one of our most profound questions: Are we alone in the universe?

Keywords: EQ Peg, BLC-1, post-detection, media,

1. Introduction

A key question in the Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence (SETI) since its inception has been: If SETI succeeds, how would the public react? This question expands the domain of the search from one of scientific curiosity about potential cosmic company to the social sciences, philosophy, and religion. The media play a central role in shaping how audiences perceive what is happening in the world, collectively influencing it through what we are told or not told [1], and this will likely be the case with news of a potentially extraterrestrial signal.

Surprisingly, despite more than half a century of research on post-detection scenarios, there has been little focus on the nexus between the supplier of the news about a putative detection (traditional and social media) and the receiver (global public audiences) apart from those written by the authors mostly 25 years ago [2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7]. There are a few papers focusing on SETI and risk communication considerations [8, 9], and many that focus on post-detection. However, there are no other papers on SETI and the media. Traditional and social

media are necessarily the conduits through which SETI scientists respond to public interest in a discounted or confirmed signal. For example, 25 years ago, SETI was an experiment most people had not heard about. However, today the situation is reversed, possibly due to social media. SETI is now a high-profile and broadly understood entity. Whatever post-detection scenarios we may consider, they will be viewed through the lenses of traditional and new media, making it essential to understand the perspectives of the media in breaking a story about a signal that SETI scientists are still trying to analyse.

The massive rise of social media, together with how we interact with it, also changes the media landscape. We have transitioned from reading newspapers, listening to the radio, and watching television to receiving news on multiple electronic devices, including smartphones, iPads, computers, and smartwatches. What has changed is not merely the mode, but the magnitude of the audience and exposure to the news across multiple platforms.

There are also differences in the way audiences consume news compared to the past 25 years. Print,

radio, and television are all mostly one-way communication modes, characterised by passive consumption on fixed schedules or dependent on the purchase of a newspaper or magazine. There are few opportunities for direct audience engagement, unlike social and digital media, where audience engagement is multi-way 24/7.

In the late 1990s, traditional media created a common environment (at least in the Western world) in which we could discuss *Friends* or *Seinfeld* as a universal cultural experience. Social media has eliminated the uniform nature of news sources. As Ott & Mack [10] point out, this lack of a common media frame of reference means we can no longer make generalised claims about the influence of the media on individual beliefs, values, attitudes, and behaviours. Nevertheless, SETI does have a universal cultural framework, despite this problem, because most people have an opinion on life elsewhere in the universe, as evidenced by surveys indicating that most of the public believes life exists elsewhere in the universe [11, 12, 13].

In the context of these changes, we pose a specific question about a claimed detection in 1998 that garnered media attention for more than a week, as it was published by a respected source: BBC online news, which received 25 million unique visits per month at the time. The BBC is highly influential globally. Today it has 434 million unique visits a month, has a staff of 5,000 journalists in more than 50 newsrooms worldwide, and publishes in 40 languages. Its key audiences are in the US, UK, India, Canada, and Australia. It is publicly funded, freely available and a trusted source of news. In America, the only source of information that is trusted more than the BBC is the weather channel [14].

Would the case of the EQ Peg hoax replay in the same way in today's media landscape? We revisit two papers by the authors, published consecutively in 1999 and 2000. *The Case of EQ Peg: Response and Challenge* [2] and *The Immediate Reaction Plan* [3].

2. The EQ Peg incident

The EQ Peg incident occurred in late 1998, when a UK amateur astronomer claimed to have detected a SETI signal from the direction of the star EQ Pegasi. He supported this claim with a plot of the signal (Fig. 1), which prompted BBC Online News coverage that was subsequently picked up by international media.

The claim originated from outside the SETI Institute, so they had no details to comment on except that the claim was unlikely to be genuine because the image produced appeared unusual.

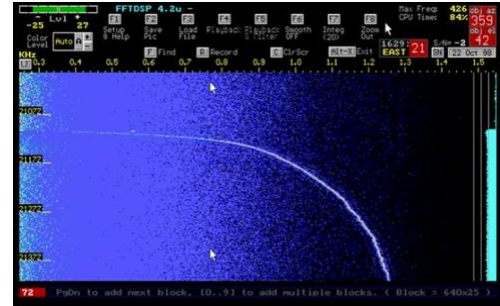


Fig. 1. Claimed signal from EQ Pegasi by a UK part-time amateur astronomer, as picked up by his company's satellite dish.

In the face of an apparent lack of more information from SETI scientists, the BBC's Science Editor, Dr David Whitehouse, was faced with the choice of publishing to see where it would go or to ignore the claim. The latter runs the risk of it turning out to be genuine and a competitor 'scooping' the story. Whitehouse chose the former and published the story [15], resulting in other media picking it up.

While it is an example of how a story can quickly gain momentum, perhaps the more salient point that remains today is how SETI scientists would respond to the media if the detection from outside the SETI community turns out to be real where there is little to no information available because they have not detected the signal. Should they, for example, take the opportunity make a short media release regardless of whether they are approached or not? Or is it best not to get involved? The question deserves more thought, as discoveries are often made outside of the scientific experiments designed to achieve the intended outcome. In this case, the story was in the UK, so Whitehouse, a radio astronomer himself, sought information from UK sources [16]. He called Ian Morison at Jodrell Bank radio telescope and quoted him in the story. Whitehouse makes it clear in the story it is likely to be from a satellite or a hoax, but it nevertheless prompted more media.

The EQ Peg story ran for five days – notably including a weekend when researchers are typically unavailable. The story reached Australia. Ray Norris, then working at the Australia Telescope National Facility, took an opportunity to slip in a search for the signal, but none was found. It provided the bookend from a trusted source for Whitehouse, who ran another story [17] as a result, reporting the signal as an apparent hoax, halting further speculation.

Whitehouse points out that the original story was not about the claim of a detection “*but the activities around the claim as scientists wondered if it was real or not, making the ambiguity the heart of the story*”. His follow up story includes input from the SETI League and Frank Drake. The few paragraphs of the story are salient, in which he says SETI may be able to learn much about how

to interact with the media in the five days the story ran. Detecting an intelligent civilisation elsewhere in the universe would rank as “one of the major discoveries of all time.”

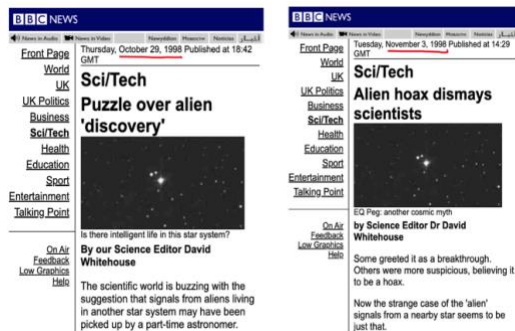


Fig.2. Clips from the BBC Online EQ Peg story five days' apart (October 29 and November 3, 1998).

Two papers arose from the incident, both by the authors. In 1999, the first paper, "The Case of EQ Peg: Response and Challenge" [2], drew parallels between this incident and the poorly media-managed Three Mile Island nuclear accident, as well as the successfully media-managed Hebe Reef disaster, comparing them to the media responses to the EQ Peg incident. It highlighted that it is not just technical verification, but also fast and accurate communication from authoritative sources to minimise misinformation and avoid loss of credibility and trust from public audiences, or in this case to have a plan when there is a claimed detection from elsewhere.

3. Immediate Reaction Plan

The second paper, published in 2000, addresses how SETI could better prepare for interactions with the media. The authors proposed an Immediate Reaction Plan (IRP) – a single, password-protected read-and-write repository for SETI researchers to store candidate signals or hoaxes [3]. The plan could facilitate the accurate and rapid dissemination of information from the SETI community to the public audience. All the data would be made available to key people in the SETI community whom the media would call to provide more authoritative sources for the media to call on. In addition, in a signal that is progressing toward confirmation, it will reduce the number of authoritative sources because they are concentrating on analysis, not the media – perhaps a critical consideration for SETI scientists in when and especially *how* they respond to media requests. The basis for the IRP is that any putative detection will take longer to discount than the news cycle, as illustrated in Table 1

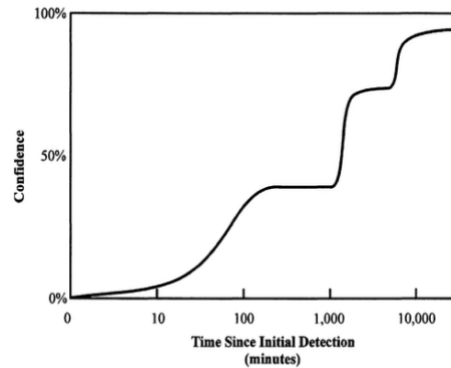


Table 1. Confidence in a putative signal over seven days (from Shostak and Oliver, 2000).

Would an IRP work? On June 24, 1997, SETI astronomers at the Green Bank radio observatory in West Virginia believed for several hours that they had detected a candidate signal apparently coming from the star system YZ Ceti, 12 light-years away. When science journalist William Broad called from *The New York Times*, inquiring about it. Shostak told him, “We regularly get such signals – it’s a consequence of the experiment, but I’ll call you if it turns out to be interesting” [4]. Broad did not publish the information at the time, for a reason that can make sense to the media. There may be no story in “we regularly get such signals” depending on the journalist and it is truthful, meeting the transparency expected of SETI.

The source of the signal turned out to be the sun-grazing SOHO (Solar and Heliospheric Observatory) spacecraft, illustrating the challenges of distinguishing genuine extraterrestrial signals from man-made RFI such as that produced by our spacecraft and satellites. Broad was informed, and he still did not publish a story, though he referred to the incident months later in a broader piece on SETI. Had an IRP been in place, the same outcome could potentially have been achieved.

The incident remains a case study in science communication and media management – a practical example of steps to take when journalists inquire about an unannounced candidate signal. However, the 1997 incident was a relatively easy call. Not so easy is a signal that is progressing towards the level that one or more journal papers will be written or confirmation. How have other possible SETI signals that reached the public domain played out?

4. Seven cases in 65 years of searching

In 65 years of SETI experiments, only six candidate narrow-band signals and one candidate technosignature have garnered attention in the media (Table 2).

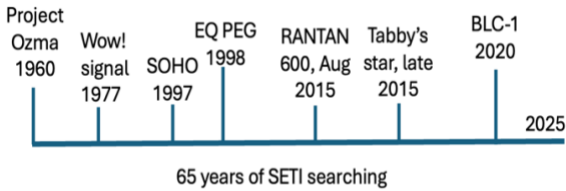


Table 2. Candidate SETI signals and a candidate technosignature gaining media coverage in the past 65 years

While all of these have been dismissed as of human origin upon further investigation, several continue to appear in the public domain as unresolved. Of the seven incidents, only EQ Peg in 1998 and BLC-1 in 2020 have been reported in the media. The rest occurred in circumstances where the media did not ‘break’ the story. Others played out in different ways. The Wow! Signal of 1977, detected by the now-disassembled Ohio State University Big Ear telescope, received little media attention at the time but is now an incident that frequently appears on social media. The interest in the signal continues despite a 2024 paper suggesting that an emission from cold hydrogen could have been responsible [18], although this claim is in doubt. Frank Drake’s 1960 Project Ozma detection of a signal apparently coming from the nearby star system Epsilon Eridani proved to be from an unexpected source close to home – possibly a military plane. The Russians quickly dismissed the signal detected by its RANTAN 600 radio telescope as radio frequency interference (RFI). Tabby’s Star (KIC 8462852) was not a signal but a claimed technosignature. The observed periodic dimming of the star prompted speculation an alien megastructure was the cause. It remains an enigma that occasionally appears in the media.

6. BLC-1: Echoes of the past?

BLC-1 (Breakthrough Listen Candidate-1) was detected during BL’s Parkes Radio Telescope deployment in New South Wales, Australia. It appeared to be coming from the red dwarf star Proxima Centauri, 4.2 light-years away and part of a triple star system that includes the G-type star, Alpha Centauri. When the telescope was moved off the source, it disappeared and reappeared when the antenna was moved back – a typical stratagem for establishing an extraterrestrial source for a candidate signal.

The UK *Guardian* newspaper heard about the ongoing analysis, contacted Breakthrough Listen and ran the story on 18 December 2020. More media attention followed *The Guardian* report, extending as far as Australia, where it appeared on Channel Seven’s news. The latter may have been due, in part, to the signal originating from Australia’s Parkes radio telescope. Proximity is one of the elements in what makes the news.

Others pertinent to SETI include impact (how many people does it affect?), currency, timeliness, novelty, and relevance.

According to BL’s Director Andrew Siemion, the team responded to at least a dozen more media requests. However, the papers were necessarily still a year away, while knowledge of the signal was in the media and therefore in the public domain long before it was ideal. It gives pause for thought in the event of a confirmed detection, as mentioned earlier. The process of analysis takes longer than the media’s interest in it will allow. SETI is not secret.

The BLC-1 story was developing into the prospect of one or more papers when the media called. The response was “We have a signal of interest, but we are still analysing it” with that SETI regularly gets such signals. However, it is now a clear story because it is a “*signal of interest*” with the potential for it to be confirmed later, however unlikely. And even if SETI scientists dismiss the signal, the story remains a story because it was an interesting signal. It has a different meaning in the public domain where trust plays a role in what audience believe. For SETI scientists, it is what the data tells them – no trust or belief is involved.

The problem for SETI scientists is what to say about a signal and when to say it. The choice is “*We get these all the time,*” or does it fall into the category of a “*signal of interest*” (from which a paper is likely to arise). The difference lies in how journalists interpret whether something is news, as we have described, and hence the distinction between the 1997 non-story Soho incident and the 2020 story BLC-1 signal. Broad was more of a features journalist, while Whitehouse was a news journalist at the time.

Which category a candidate signal falls into could be defined by “*what do we know that is over and above the other candidates we rapidly dismiss?*” but it is essential there is continuing information from SETI scientists to the media, once the media calls, even if the signal is now progressing towards the ‘dismissed’ basket.

Prof. Jason Wright, head of the Penn State Extraterrestrial Centre and a member of the BL team, lamented on his website, *Astrowright*, that the leak had left a gap between *The Guardian*’s breaking of the story and the papers. He did not have enough information, except what the media was reporting [19]. Journalists often shape the story without approaching BL, despite the BL team being willing to respond to media (and, in fact, did respond to the journalists who approached them). Wright said:

“...we’re left to read the tea leaves and parse vague newspaper statements instead of reading their paper on the topic (which does not exist because they’re not done with their analysis!)” [20].



Fig.3. The UK *Guardian* BLC-1 story from December 2020.

Breakthrough Listen produced a plain-English website resource for journalists when the papers were published in 2021, and that remains available today [21]. It includes images, video, and text. However, the story rattles on with some believing that BLC-1 is still a candidate signal of interest [22]. It's not clear whether a website was raised as soon as the media interest began, though Wright's comment suggests it was not (and probably not a consideration for BL at the time). No press conference was held. The risk was it might inflame in some way, according to BL [23]. These are difficult calls to make in the process of the event, and again points to more research on the interface between SETI and the media, undertaken by those in the SETI community who are experienced in responding to the media and journalists – probably mostly science editors and correspondents.

The EQ Peg hoax had some similarity to the BLC-1 media in the sense that there was no detail to share except to say that the SETI League had checked and found no signal to be detected. It was closer to the experience of the SETI Institute in the 1997 SOHO probe incident. The IRP (Table 1) predicts the difference between the time it takes to analyse a signal and media interest before analysis is complete. It is difficult to imagine this will not happen in a promising signal progressing to confirmation.

6. Changes in media reach and nature over time

Another difference between the EQ Peg hoax and the BLC-1 incident is the change in media reach and nature over time. In 1998, at the time of the EQ Peg incident, the internet was starting to gain a foothold. For example, in 1997, 18.6 million households in the US had an internet connection. By 2003, the number had almost tripled to 54 million. Much of our knowledge of the contemporary world is 'mediated,' and much of this comes from traditional and social media. According to Ott and Mack, "Mass media largely determine what we talk and care about." [10]. Initially, the rise of the internet and traditional media (print, radio, and television) occurred without one substantially impacting the other. According to Nguyen [24], online news complements traditional media, especially newspapers, where it is more

information intensive. The net result was that between 1998 and 2003, those who used the internet still relied on traditional media. By 2020, traditional media with an online presence had grown dramatically, as shown in Table 3.

Global per month	Unique visitors 1998	Unique visitors 2025
New York Times	7.5 million	240 million
The Guardian	25 million	113 million
BBC news	25 million	434 million
CNN	Unknown	215 million

Table 3. Four news outlets show the dramatic increase in unique visitors per month between 1998, when the EQ Peg incident occurred, and the 2020 announcement of the BLC-1 candidate signal.

However, as large as the numbers are in Table 3 for traditional media, they are relatively small compared to those for social media. Around 5.56 billion people (approximately 68% of the world's population) are now connected to the internet, and they are mostly active social media users exposed to news content across multiple platforms [25]. YouTube has the highest number of monthly unique users – 2.5 billion by early 2025. The average social media user engages with more than six platforms per month, although the time spent on each platform has declined to 141 minutes – ten minutes per day less than in 2003. The 2024 Reuters Institute Digital News Report, a YouGov survey of more than 95,000 people in 47 countries, represents half the world's population. It indicates that social media platforms are growing in news consumption and production, and that they are becoming more visual and video-led on platforms such as YouTube, TikTok, and Instagram [26]. In the US, for 54% of the public, the main source of news is social media [27].

The term 'social media' hides its diversity. We now have social networking sites, microblogging platforms, media-sharing networks, discussion and community forums, decentralised and messaging networks, and collaborative wikis. This dizzying array of platforms is a seismic shift from professionally produced content with editorial oversight of user-generated content. More recently, AI chatbots have entered the news media sphere. For example, the *Washington Post* has launched Climate Answers, and *Forbes* and the *Financial Times* have chatbots to help readers navigate their article archives [28]. Such developments make it challenging to determine whether the EQ Peg hoax would unfold in the same way today. It is no longer a matter of comparing apples with apples, but a situation in which we cannot avoid comparing apples with oranges.

7. Videos, documentaries and blogs

Another difference between now and 25 years ago is that the stories of SETI false positives persist through their appearance on YouTube videos, documentaries, blogs, podcasts, and radio and television shows. Good examples of these are the Wow! signal, BLC-1, and Tabby's Star as a search of YouTube will confirm. Storytelling is the most effective form of communication [29] – our brains are hardwired by evolution to interpret information as stories, as demonstrated by the work of Princeton neuroscientist Uri Hasson [30]. Stories help us remember. It makes calculating the impact – especially long-term impacts – on the public psyche impossible to do.

8. SETI in our culture

The repeated exposure to the SETI enterprise in multiple media has undoubtedly contributed to the change from a relatively small number of people knowing about it to it becoming part of our culture. A recent example of this assertion is London's historic Natural History Museum, which houses an exhibition on the search for life in the universe (Fig. 4).

Public audiences are not only interested in the question of whether we are alone in the universe, but the majority of those surveyed believe we are not alone – that there is not only life in the universe, but intelligent life.

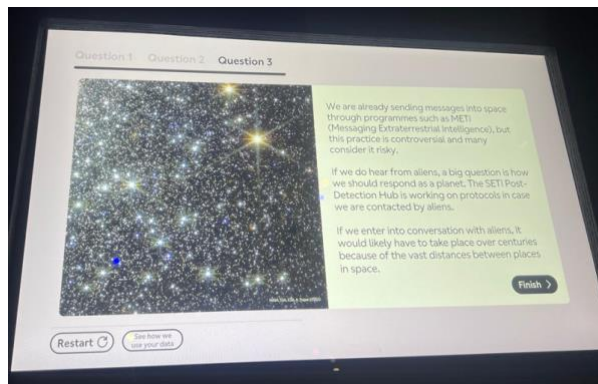


Fig.4. A question from London's Natural History Museum's exhibition on the search for life in the universe.

The most extensive study of the public's opinion on extraterrestrial life was a 2017 Glocalities study [11] of 26,492 people across 24 countries, which found that most people believe we are not alone in the universe. Of those surveyed, 61% think there is some form of life among the stars, 17% ruled it out, and 22% had no opinion. Almost half of the respondents (47%) believe we share the universe with other intelligent civilisations, while 26% rule it out and 28% say they don't know. Among the 47% who are convinced that we share the cosmos with other intelligent beings, 60% say we should try to get in touch, while 21% are against the idea and 19% are unsure.

In 2021, a Pew Research Center study [12] found a similar situation among Americans, with 65% saying their best guess was that intelligent life existed on other worlds, 34% disagreeing, and 2% giving no answer.

More recently, in 2025, a UK YouGov survey [13] found 75% of Britons think aliens exist somewhere in the universe, with few doubting it (only 14%). Most of those who think we are not alone also think we are either not advanced enough to detect alien civilisations or there is some other technological impediment to making contact.

Beliefs exert a substantial influence on attitudes towards news by shaping how individuals interpret information, weigh sources and respond to media coverage, and that also applies to SETI. Public audiences start with their own beliefs and values when interpreting the messages of science in the media, but they often find it challenging to make sense of scientific information, and that has probably not changed much in 25 years. It underscores the need to examine the SETI relationship with today's media beyond the outlets that serve interested and educated audiences, and how trust and belief in media content have a role in the perception of SETI news.

9. Other considerations for SETI and the media

In 1988, Andrew Fraknoi, a US astronomer and writer and a member of the SETI Institute Board, undertook what may have been the first research on SETI and the media. He asked 29 science journalists across the US how they would handle the news of a SETI success and what their needs would be [31]. These were journalists from newspapers (including national ones), magazines, wire services, radio, and television – all in the category of traditional media, as the internet had not been invented and social media was decades away. The paper provides a historical foundation for further research. However, among Fraknoi's conclusions is one that underscores why more research is needed:

"How the public perceives the story will be very significantly coloured by how journalists understand and present it."

In other words, the framing matters in the public perception of a discovery (and who assists with that framing for journalists without a science background). Most traditional media today no longer have science editors.

It would be hubris to suggest that SETI practitioners have any control over how the media frames a putative SETI detection. However, thought should be given to whether it is possible to influence accuracy of the news of an interesting signal. Use of knowledge of how SETI stories can be propagated in the media might be possible. There are known sources that influence other media. In the US it is *The New York Times*; in the UK, it is *The Guardian* and the *BBC*; and in Australia, it is the *Sydney Morning Herald*.

Influencing the propagation of SETI stories was demonstrated in 2000 when Frank Drake visited Australia to attend the *SETI in the 21st Century* and agreed to engage with the media. He told the Sydney Morning Herald that a SETI success is most likely to be made in Australia because it looks into the centre of the galaxy. That story was syndicated to newspapers in every major city in Australia, as well as all the key radio and television stations. In a week, he gave 40 media interviews and raised the profile of SETI in Australia [5]. Traditional media still influences social media, and undoubtedly it is still possible for SETI to use this tool for the right story, possibly including influencing the level of accuracy in future interesting signals that are detected.

10. Discussion

It is difficult to say whether the EQ Peg incident would play out differently today. To begin with, we cannot compare the largely traditional media landscape of the late 1990s/early 2000s with today's social media landscape, which serves as the main source of news. In addition, aside from social media, more people are exposed to news now. Twenty-five years ago, the global population was 6.1 billion. Today it is 8.2 billion. At that time, most people were unaware of SETI, whereas today, most people are aware that scientists are searching for life elsewhere in the universe.

Nevertheless, the EQ Peg incident provides insight into an unanticipated scenario where a claimed signal originates from outside the SETI community. In the case of EQ Peg, the SETI Institute could not provide any useful comment because they were not approached on the first piece that Whitehouse ran, only the second one. How SETI scientists would respond to detection claims from outside the SETI community is worthy of further thought since it is not an outside possibility.

BLC-1 was an entirely different type of incident, but it serves to illustrate how SETI scientists perceive a candidate signal and the point at which journalists view it as a story. It underscores the difference between how SETI scientists see the data in analysing a signal and how trust and belief play a role in how the public consumes the news via the media and how it frames information. We have only touched on this aspect, but again an area worthy of further study relating to SETI and the media.

The ongoing analysis of a “*signal of interest*” makes it intriguing for the media and the possibility that it could be the beginning of a confirmed signal. The IRP describes this tension, since at any point on the analysis curve, a leak to the media could occur, and is likely the scenario in a confirmed detection. At this point, SETI scientists must decide on the response. Is it “*We get these signals all the time*” or is it “*We are in the process of analysing an interesting signal*”. Both are the truth. The former may be seen as not news, but the latter is. BL did

not hold a press conference for fear of inflaming the situation, but the question is whether once in the media, is the risk of inflaming a better option than “*reading the tea leaves*”? It is a difficult question and another item for research on the relationship between SETI and the media.

Another issue may be the availability of SETI scientists to respond to the media if a signal appears increasingly likely to be confirmed. It is highly questionable whether those engaged in analysing the signal will want to devote time to the press – but at the top of this curve where the rubber hits the road, how will SETI cope with the deluge. Far from having champagne on ice, there should be a media plan to be opened first when the media calls, worked out with those who know best: the media and those within the SETI community who have expertise in how the media operates.

We encourage further consideration of whether an IRP would be beneficial. The SETI Institute and Breakthrough Listen, both available to journalists, are the two most significant organisations engaging in SETI experiments, but they are primarily located on the US West Coast. There are also trusted experts in related organisations scattered around the globe who can respond to questions from the media, overcoming a potential time zone issue in dealing with media requests – making it important for information to be available to them. The EQ Peg and BLC-1 cases, separated by 25 years and both in the UK, both prompted extensive media coverage. These experts are members of the International Academy of Astronautics SETI Committee which focuses on creating and maintaining post-detection protocols. Several years ago, the SETI Post-Detection Hub was established at the University of St Andrews in Fife, Scotland, with a membership that includes SETI scientists and a broad range of other experts who are available to the media. Penn State University's Extraterrestrial Center is another organisation that has garnered media respect.

The transformation of today's media landscape means SETI now regularly appears in traditional, social, and digital media, not just through events like candidate signals, but also in examinations of those false positives for many years, the Wow! signal being among the most regularly creating interest.

Candidate signals are the consequence of SETI research, creating the ongoing fodder to feed both traditional and social media. That leads to re-examining a recommendation in a NASA report on the *Social Implication of Detecting an Extraterrestrial Civilization* led by John Billingham [32]. It urged the SETI community to:

“*Devise a method of regularly reminding the public that false alarms...will be a frequent and ongoing result of SETI research*”.

The public's belief that we are not alone in the universe, coupled with a transformed media landscape

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